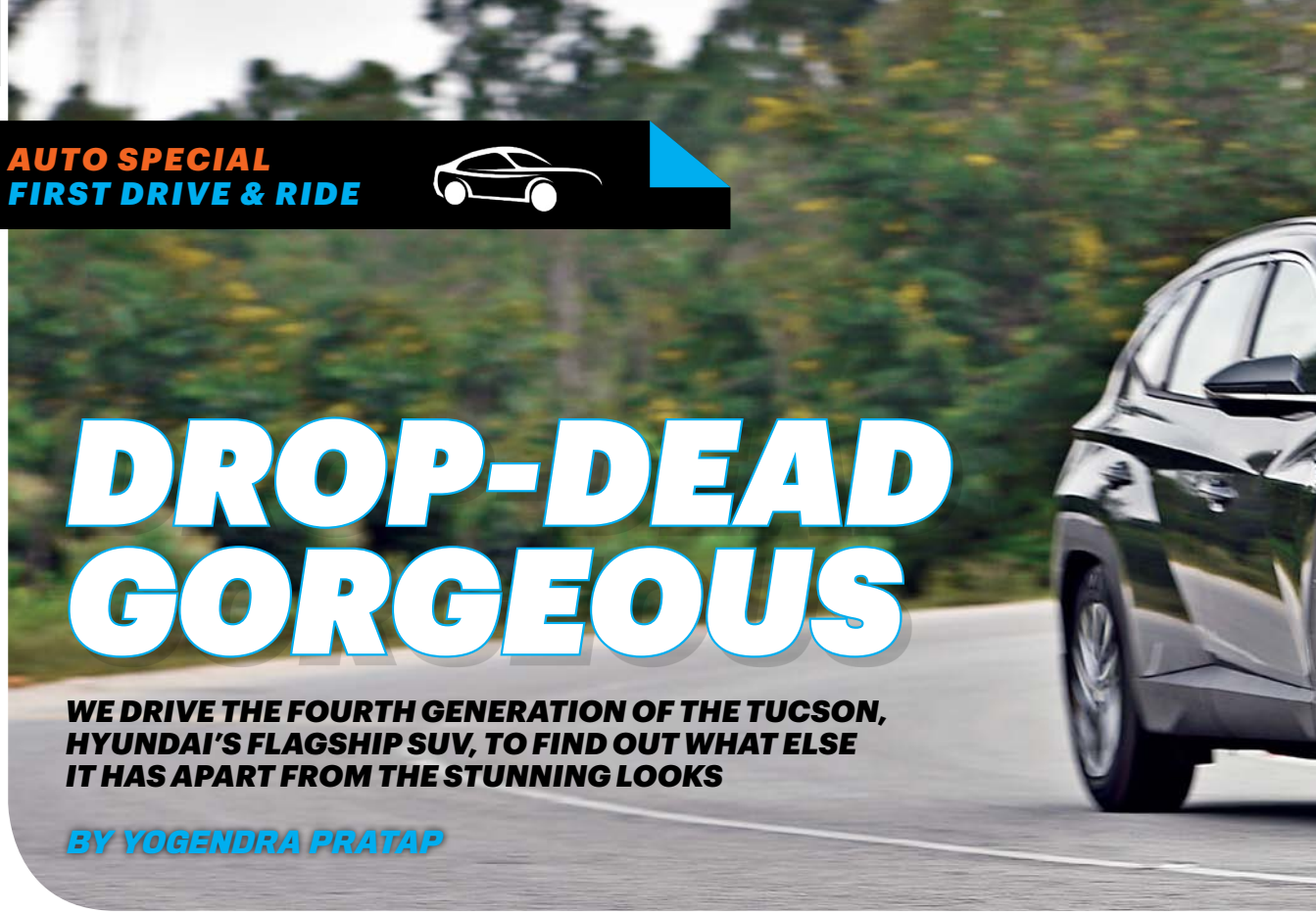


DROP-DEAD GORGEOUS

WE DRIVE THE FOURTH GENERATION OF THE TUCSON, HYUNDAI'S FLAGSHIP SUV, TO FIND OUT WHAT ELSE IT HAS APART FROM THE STUNNING LOOKS

BY YOGENDRA PRATAP

I had driven the fourth-generation Tucson late last year in the US and was eagerly waiting to drive it in India to see what all changes Hyundai would make to the car considering that this would be their flagship in the country.

The exteriors of the new Tucson in India are exactly the same as on the car that I had driven last year and my first opinions on the looks of the car are exactly the same today. I had said that for the fourth generation Tucson, Hyundai has taken design to another level, mixing advanced lighting tech with design elements to accomplish what SangYup Lee, the head of Hyundai's Global Design Centre, has been calling sensuous sportiness in a mission to elevate the emotional qualities of automotive design. Geometric patterns that Hyundai is calling parametric jewels are repeated throughout the design of the vehicle and are further enhanced by the innovative use of lighting technologies. For example, when the lights are switched off, one cannot make out that the DRLs are integrated into the parametric design elements of the grille. Hyundai is calling these Parametric Hidden Lights and the feature has been used in the tail-lights as well. This design feature has also been used on the sides as well as on the rear bumper with both featuring parametric jewel-like design elements.

The instrument panel is digital like that on the Alcazar but bigger and is one of the two 10.25-inch screens to be found on the Tucson but with even more features. The second 10.25-inch screen is a touchscreen and serves as a display for the infotainment system. While on the US-spec Tucson, the gear shift lever was missing with shift-by-wire technology replacing the gear-lever with buttons, Hyundai India plays it safe and goes with a conventional gear shift lever. That apart, the big change is also the addition of the full range of ADAS features as well as a Bose surround





